

PILOT EDITION

The 12-Week Tech Journal

Get church tech out of your head — from scattered notes to one written place.

Raytech Services

Fillable AcroForm · Print or type · US Letter

Write it down. Serve well.

Keep this book like the church checkbook — locked drawer or safe when filled in.

Hi. Read this first.

Hi, my name is Adam. I've spent 20 years in IT, and a lot of that time has been helping churches get organized.

Every time I start work at a new church, I ask the same questions. Where's the internet box? Who has the passwords? Who pays for the website? Most of the time the answers live in one person's head, and that person is tired of carrying it all.

So I made the journal I wish every one of my clients had filled out before I walked in the door. I hope you find it useful and easy to understand.

If you have feedback, there's a short form on raytech.co (look for the journal page). I read every answer, and it shapes next year's edition. And if you ever want help beyond this book, reach out, or visit raytech.co for more resources.

Adam Raymer-Brown, Raytech Services

Here's the deal I'm making with you:

You will not fix anything in this book. You're only writing down what's already there.

You do not need to be "a computer person." If you can fill out a permission slip, you can do this.

It takes about 20 minutes, once a week, for 12 weeks. Then you stop. Really.

"I don't know" is a good answer. Write it down and move on. A blank tells you something, too.

Nobody is grading this. There's no wrong way to do it.

When you finish, your church will have one written place that says what you have, where it is, who takes care of it, and who to call. If you're out sick for two weeks, somebody else can pick up this book and keep things going. That's the whole point.

One big rule: no passwords in this book

Never write an actual password in here. Not one. You'll write down where the passwords are kept and who can get to them. That's safer, and it's all anyone needs.

Where to keep this book

When it's filled in, this book shows who holds the keys to everything. Treat it like the church checkbook. Keep it in a locked drawer or the church safe, not on the front counter. If you fill it in on a computer, keep the file somewhere only staff can open.

How each week works

- 1. Pick a day and a quiet 20 minutes. Same day each week helps.
- 2. Read the short note at the top.
- 3. Fill in what you know. Skip what you don't.
- 4. Check the "You're done" box. Close the book. You're done for the week.
- 5. Glance at "What to bring next week" so next week is easy.

Pick your people

One person owns this book. Other people help on their weeks.

WHO	WHAT THEY HELP WITH	NAME
Book owner (usually the office admin)	Most weeks	
Backup (can open this book if owner is out)	Knows where the book is kept	
Sunday tech helper (sound, slides, livestream)	Weeks 2, 4, 9	
Treasurer or bookkeeper	Weeks 6 and 8	
Pastor	Reads Week 12 and signs it	

The 12 weeks at a glance

	WEEKS	WHAT YOU'LL WRITE DOWN
The basics	1–4	People, equipment, where passwords are kept, internet and phones
Everyday tools and bills	5–8	Email, giving and member records, files, what you pay for
If something goes wrong	9–12	Backup copies, who has access, who to call, your one-page summary

What a finished week looks like

EXAMPLE · MAPLE STREET CHURCH · WEEK 3 · NOT FILLABLE

Here's Week 3 filled in by a made-up church, Maple Street Church, so you can see how little it takes. Notice the blanks and the "don't knows." That's a finished page. (Maple Street and everyone in it are invented for this example.)

Where are the church's passwords kept today?

- ☒ A paper notebook (where?): Carol's top desk drawer, green notebook
- ☒ Sticky notes: two on the office monitor (wifi and copier code)
- ☒ Saved in the web browser on one computer: front office computer, Chrome
- ☒ In someone's head (whose?): Dave knows all the sound booth and YouTube ones

Who can get to the passwords?

First person: Carol (office)

Second person: nobody right now

☐ The pastor can get in during an emergency, or knows who can. Pastor Jim said he'd have to call Carol.

Important accounts (sample answers)

ACCOUNT	WRITTEN DOWN SAFE?	CHURCH OR PERSONAL?	RESET GOES TO
Church email (boss)	Y, notebook	Church	Carol's cell
Website / web address	?	Personal, Mark's Gmail	Mark (moved away)
Online giving	Y, notebook	Church	Treasurer's email
Member records	Y	Church	Carol's cell
Facebook	N	Personal (Carol & Dave)	n/a
Internet provider	?	?	Don't know — ask treasurer
Livestream (YouTube)	N, Dave's head	Personal, Dave's Gmail	Dave's cell
Online file storage	None — office computer		
Bookkeeping software	Y, treasurer keeps it	Church	Treasurer

Accounts that text a code to someone's phone: Church email and giving both text Carol. YouTube texts Dave.

Honest check

- ☒ One person holds almost all the keys. (Carol, and Dave for Sundays)
- ☒ We've had a "nobody can get in" scramble in the last year. YouTube, when Dave had the flu
- ☐ Several people share one login for something
- ☒ Done for this week. Took 25 minutes. Didn't fix a thing.

See what Carol did? She didn't change a password or call anyone. But now Maple Street knows three things it didn't know before: there's no second person, the website is under the name of someone who moved away, and Sunday's livestream depends on Dave's phone. That's a good week's work.

Who does what

About 20 minutes. You can do this one alone.

For example. The internet goes out on a Thursday. The secretary figures the pastor called it in. The pastor figures the sound guy did. The sound guy doesn't even know it's out. Sunday morning comes and it's still down. Nobody did anything wrong. There just wasn't a name next to the job.

This week you're just putting names next to jobs. If a job has no name, or every job has the same name, that's worth knowing. Don't fix it. Just write it.

Write it down

Church name:

Who does each job now? Who could step in?

JOB	WHO DOES IT NOW	WHO COULD STEP IN
Checks the church email		
Handles wifi and internet trouble		
Looks after online giving		
Updates the website		
Runs Sunday sound, slides, or livestream		
Posts on Facebook or other social media		
Sets up email or logins for a new person		
Pays the tech bills		

☐ If the pastor needed tech help today, the pastor knows who to call:

☐ I counted how many jobs have the same name (out of 8):

☐ I counted how many "could step in" boxes are blank (out of 8):

Anything that gets stuck a lot around here? (check any)

☐ We wait on one person

☐ We hunt for who has the password

☐ We don't know who to ask

☐ Something else:

You're done when

every job has a name or an honest blank.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ Your phone, for taking pictures of the stickers on the back or bottom of equipment

☐ A helper who knows the sanctuary equipment, if that isn't you

☐ Person to ask:

Equipment and where it lives

About 25 minutes. Walk around. Bring your phone.

For example. Someone asks where the church iPad is. It was last seen at Vacation Bible School. After a week of asking around, it turns up in a tote bag in a volunteer's trunk, with a dead battery and a passcode nobody remembers. It wasn't lost, exactly. It just didn't have a home that anyone had written down.

Walk through the office and the sanctuary. List anything the church depends on that plugs in or charges. Rough is fine.

Write it down

WHAT IT IS	WHERE IT LIVES	WHO USES IT	OWNED? Y/N/?	ABOUT HOW OLD

Did you remember...

- ☐ Office computer(s)
- ☐ Pastor's or staff laptops (if the church bought them)
- ☐ Printer or copier
- ☐ Tablets or phones used for check-in or ministry
- ☐ The computer that runs Sunday slides or the livestream
- ☐ Sound board, cameras, projector or TVs
- ☐ The internet box (you'll look closer at it in Week 4)

Two honest questions:

Church equipment at someone's house or car:

Personal equipment the church depends on:

Piece that would hurt most if it quit tomorrow:

Tip: Take a picture of the sticker on the back or bottom of each item (model and serial). Where will you keep these pictures?

Pictures kept:

You're done when

you have a simple list and you know where each thing normally sits.

- ☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

- ☐ Wherever passwords are kept right now (you won't copy them — just note where)
- ☐ The name of anyone who "just knows" the passwords

☐ Person to ask:

Where the passwords are kept

About 20 minutes. Remember: no actual passwords in this book.

For example. Every church has a Linda. Linda knows the password to everything. Linda is wonderful. Then Linda goes on a cruise, the email locks up on Tuesday, and nobody can get in until she's back on dry land. Linda did nothing wrong. She was just the only copy.

This week you are not changing a single password. You're writing down where they're kept and who can get to them.

Write it down

Where are the church's passwords kept today? (check all that are true)

- ☐ A password app (name):
- ☐ A spreadsheet or document (where?):
- ☐ A paper notebook (where?):
- ☐ Sticky notes
- ☐ Saved in the web browser on one computer (which?):
- ☐ In someone's head (whose?):

A word you might see

"Password manager." That's an app that acts like a locked notebook for passwords. 1Password and Bitwarden are two common ones. You don't need one to finish this book. Just write down what you really use today.

Who can get to the passwords?

First person:

Second person:

- ☐ The pastor can get in during an emergency, or knows who can

The important accounts — three small questions each.

ACCOUNT	SAFE? Y/N/?	CHURCH/PERSONAL/?	RESET GOES TO
Church email (main "boss" account)			
Website and web address			
Online giving			
Member records			
Facebook / social media			
Internet provider account			
Livestream (YouTube, etc.)			
Online file storage			
Bookkeeping software			

A word you might see

Why that last column matters. When you click "Forgot password," the reset goes to a phone or email typed in years ago. If that belongs to someone who moved away, the church can get locked out. You're not fixing that today — just finding out.

A word you might see

"Two-step sign-in" (2-step, two-factor, MFA): the account texts a code to a phone. Note whose phone gets the code — if that person leaves, the codes leave with them.

Accounts that text a code (and whose phone):

Honest check:

- ☐ One person holds almost all the keys
- ☐ We've had a "nobody can get in" scramble in the last year
- ☐ Several people share one login for something (which?):

You're done when

you know where the passwords are kept and who can reach them.

- ☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

- ☐ A recent internet bill
- ☐ A recent phone bill
- ☐ Your phone, for a picture of the internet box
- ☐ Person to ask:

Internet, wifi, and phones

About 20 minutes. Your Sunday tech helper is useful here.

For example. The wifi drops in the middle of the livestream. Everyone turns and looks at the sound booth. The volunteer in the booth is great with the sound board, but he has never seen the internet box and doesn't know which closet it's in. It turns out the fix was unplugging it and plugging it back in. It took forty minutes to find it and ten seconds to fix it.

Write it down

Internet

Company:

Whose name is on the account:

Account number is kept (where — not the number):

Phone to call when it's down:

About how much a month:

The internet box

Where is it? (room, shelf, closet):

Who owns it:

- ☐ the internet company
- ☐ the church
- ☐ don't know
- ☐ I took a picture of the sticker on it

Who knows how to restart it:

Who can change the wifi name or password:

A word you might see

"Router" or "modem." That's the internet box with the blinking lights. Sometimes one box, sometimes two. The sticker usually has the company's name.

Wifi

- ☐ There's one wifi for staff and a separate one for guests
- ☐ Everyone is on the same wifi
- ☐ Don't know

Where the wifi password is posted or kept:

- ☐ Sunday slides/livestream computer is plugged in with a cable (not wifi)

Phones

Church phone company:

Who can change the voicemail greeting:

Does the church number ring on a cell or app? Whose?

What goes wrong most? (check any)

- ☐ Wifi is slow or drops on Sundays
- ☐ Office is fine, sanctuary isn't
- ☐ The printer works "sometimes"
- ☐ We don't know who to call when the internet goes out
- ☐ Something else:

You're done when

the company, the account holder, the box location, and "who can restart it" are written down.

- ☐ Done for this week.

Pause. You're a third of the way. The basics are done. People, equipment, passwords, internet. That's more than most churches have ever written down.

What to bring next week

- ☐ A list of every church email address you can think of (office@, pastor@, info@ ...)
- ☐ The name of whoever set up the church email in the first place
- ☐ Person to ask:

Email and how people reach you

About 20 minutes.

For example. A family emails the "info@" address on the church website about a funeral. Days go by. It turns out nobody has opened that mailbox since the last secretary left, and there are two hundred unread messages in it. The address still worked fine. It just didn't belong to anybody anymore.

Write it down

The part of your email after the @ sign:

Your email runs on:

☐ Google

☐ Microsoft

☐ Something else:

☐ Don't know

Email "boss" (can add/remove/reset):

☐ Is there a second boss? Yes:

☐ No, only one

A word you might see

"Admin" or "administrator." That's the boss account. It can add, remove, and reset everyone else. Every church should know who theirs is. If there's only one, note it.

Every email address the church uses:

ADDRESS	WHAT IT'S FOR	WHO CHECKS IT	HOW OFTEN

☐ Some church business runs through a personal email. Whose?

☐ An old address forwards. Which, and to whom?

Other ways people reach the church:

☐ Group text (which app? who runs it?):

☐ Church app:

☐ Facebook messages (who reads them?):

☐ Newsletter / mass email (service? who sends?):

Where does a message get lost most often?

You're done when

you can list the main addresses and who watches each one.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ Your treasurer or bookkeeper, or 10 minutes of their time

☐ A statement or email from your online giving company

☐ Person to ask:

Giving and member records

About 20 minutes. Do this one with your treasurer or bookkeeper.

For example. Online giving stops working the Saturday before a big Sunday. The only person who can log in is at the lake with no signal. The giving company's help line is happy to help, but only if the person whose name is on the account calls. By Monday it's sorted out. It was just a long weekend for everyone.

Write it down

Online giving

Company or app:

Who can log in as the boss:

A second person?

Bank account money lands in (name only, no numbers):

Who matches giving to the bank statement:

Who to call if giving stops working:

☐ We also use text-to-give, a kiosk, or a card reader:

Member records

Where the member/family list is kept:

A word you might see

"ChMS" means church management software — the program that holds your member list. A spreadsheet counts. Write that down.

Who can add or change people:

Who can see giving history (short list):

Where new visitor cards/forms end up:

Child check-in — what, and who runs it:

Honest check:

☐ We type the same person's information into more than one place

☐ We're not sure what fees the giving company takes

☐ Only one person can run a giving report or fix a failed gift

☐ Year-end giving statements depend on one person:

You're done when

the giving tool, the member list, and the people who can open them are named.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ Try to find last year's budget file. Notice how long it takes.

☐ Write the time here (minutes):

☐ Person to ask:

Files and where the real copy lives

About 20 minutes.

For example. The board wants to check something in the bylaws. There are four copies. One is on the office computer, one is in the pastor's email, one is in a binder, and one is on a former clerk's laptop. They're all a little different, and nobody is sure which one was actually voted on.

Write it down

Where do the church's files live? (check all)

- ☐ Google Drive
- ☐ Microsoft OneDrive or SharePoint
- ☐ Dropbox
- ☐ On the office computer only
- ☐ On someone's personal laptop or personal account (whose?):
- ☐ USB sticks or a plug-in drive
- ☐ A filing cabinet (paper counts)

A word you might see

"The cloud" means files on a company's computers (Google, Microsoft, Dropbox) that you reach over the internet. What matters is whose account they're under.

Online account in church's name or a person's?

For each kind of file, where is the real copy?

KIND OF FILE	WHERE THE REAL COPY IS	WHO LOOKS AFTER IT
Bylaws, policies, handbooks		
Budget and finance reports		
Bulletin and newsletter templates		
Logos, photos, graphics		
Board and meeting minutes		
Sermon recordings and slides		
Insurance papers and the deed		
Background checks and child-safety forms		

- ☐ Private files can only be opened by the people who should
- ☐ Not sure who can open what

Honest check:

- ☐ We hunt for the latest version a lot
- ☐ Important files live on only one person's computer
- ☐ A new volunteer could not find last year's budget without help

You're done when

you've named the main home for files and admitted where it's fuzzy.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ The last 2–3 church credit card or bank statements (look for recurring charges)

☐ Your treasurer or bookkeeper again, if you can

☐ Person to ask:

What you pay for

About 25 minutes. Bring the card statements and your treasurer.

For example. The treasurer spots a charge in August. After some digging, it's a website tool a youth pastor signed up for years ago. He's been gone a long time, and the tool hasn't been used since. It renewed every August anyway, because the card on file was still good and nobody knew to look.

Go through the statements and list anything tech-related that charges again and again.

Write it down

WHAT IT IS	ABOUT \$	M / Y	RENEWS	CARD LAST 4	WHOSE NAME	USING?

Did you remember...

- ☐ Internet
- ☐ Phones
- ☐ Email (Google or Microsoft)
- ☐ Giving company fees
- ☐ Website hosting
- ☐ Livestream or slides software
- ☐ Song and streaming licenses (CCLI or similar)
- ☐ Bookkeeping software (QuickBooks, Aplos, or other)
- ☐ Zoom or other meeting tools
- ☐ Design tools (Canva or similar)
- ☐ Virus protection or backup service
- ☐ Anything a staff member pays personally and turns in:

Your web address gets its own box

A word you might see

"Domain" is your web address (like yourchurch.org). It's rented by the year. If the rent doesn't get paid, the website and the church email can both stop working on the same day.

Our web address:

Company we rent it from:

☐ Don't know (registrar)

Whose name and email it's under:

☐ Don't know (contact)

When it renews:

Card it charges (last 4 only):

☐ Is that card still good? Yes

☐ Not sure

Honest check:

☐ We've been surprised by a charge in the last year

☐ Something on this list might not be needed anymore:

☐ Something is on a personal or former staff card:

You're done when

you have a rough list and you know who pays for what.

☐ Done for this week.

Pause. Two-thirds done. Everyday tools and bills are on paper now. The last four weeks are about "what if."

What to bring next week

☐ Your Sunday tech helper

☐ Any plug-in backup drive, if there is one (just to see it and note where it lives)

☐ Person to ask:

If a computer died tomorrow

About 20 minutes. Your Sunday tech helper is useful here.

For example. The office computer won't turn on Monday morning. On it: ten years of bulletins, the member directory, and the budget. There's a backup drive on the shelf, which is good news. Then someone notices it was unplugged a couple of years ago to make room for a phone charger.

No fixing this week either. You're just finding out what has a second copy and what doesn't.

Write it down

If the main office computer died tomorrow:

What would be gone for good?

What is already safe somewhere else?

Second copies we have today (check all that are true):

☐ Files copy themselves online automatically (Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox)

☐ A plug-in backup drive. Where?

Who plugs it in?

☐ A backup service we pay for (name):

☐ Nothing that we know of

A word you might see

"Backup" is a second copy somewhere else. "Restore" is getting a file back. Files that sync online are handy, but a delete can sync too — so know whether you have a true second copy.

☐ Has anyone ever gotten a file back from the backup? Yes, when:

☐ No

☐ Don't know

If the usual person is away, who could get files back?

Any backup kept outside the building (fire/flood)?

Things held by other companies:

☐ We could download our own copy of giving/member records if needed

☐ Don't know (export)

Website: if it disappeared, who has a copy?

Sunday morning:

If slides/livestream PC died at 9 a.m., Plan B:

Where slides/order of service live besides that PC:

Software for slides/streaming:

You're done when

you can honestly say what has a second copy, what doesn't, and who could get it back.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ Names of staff and key volunteers who left in the last two or three years

☐ Whoever keeps the list of building keys and door codes

☐ Person to ask:

Who has access, and what happens when someone leaves

About 20 minutes.

For example. Someone is tidying up the church Facebook page and looks at who can post on it. One name is a volunteer who moved to Florida three years ago. Nobody's worried about her, she's lovely. It's just that nobody ever thought to check. It's the same as a building key that never got turned back in.

This isn't about not trusting people. It's about tidy bookkeeping, the same as getting a building key back.

Write it down

When someone new starts, what do you actually do to get them set up?

1.
2.
3.

When someone leaves, what happens to their logins?

- ☐ We have a list and follow it
- ☐ We handle it when we remember
- ☐ Honestly, we usually forget

Starter list: things to get back or turn off when someone leaves. Cross out what doesn't apply.

- ☐ Their church email (and decide who gets their old messages)
- ☐ Any shared passwords they knew
- ☐ Giving and bookkeeping logins
- ☐ Member records login
- ☐ File storage
- ☐ Facebook page and other social media
- ☐ Website login
- ☐ Wifi password, door codes, alarm code, building keys
- ☐ Church card, or their name on the bank account
- ☐ Their phone/email listed for password resets and sign-in codes (Week 3)
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Other:

Look back at the names you brought this week:

People who may still be able to get into something:

Logins that several people share:

Where the pastor's emergency way in is written down:

You're done when

you have a starter list and an honest note about how it usually goes.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

☐ Business cards, stickers on equipment, or old invoices with phone numbers

☐ Person to ask:

Who to call

About 20 minutes.

For example. The copier jams the morning of a funeral, with the bulletins half printed. Everybody knows there's "a copier guy." Nobody knows his name or his number. It turns out his sticker was on the side of the copier the whole time, facing the wall.

Write it down

WHEN THIS BREAKS	CALL	PHONE OR WEBSITE	ACCOUNT # KEPT WHERE
Internet			
Phones			
Email			
Online giving			
Member records			
Website			
Copier or printer			
Sound, slides, or livestream			
Alarm or door system			
General computer help			

Some companies will only talk to the person on the account. For your top three (internet, email, giving), who is that person?

1.
2.
3.

Can't wait until Monday:

Can wait:

Last time you needed help fast:

What made it hard?

You're done when

there's a call list for the things that keep Sunday and the office running.

☐ Done for this week.

What to bring next week

- ☐ This book, all of it (next week you'll copy the highlights onto one page)
- ☐ 10 minutes on the pastor's calendar to read the page with you
- ☐ Person to ask:

Your one-page summary

About 30 minutes. This is the page someone grabs when you're not there.

Here's what I hope happens. Some Tuesday you're home sick. Something at church stops working. Instead of calling you, somebody opens the drawer, pulls out one page, and makes the right phone call. You find out about it the next week. That's what this page is for.

You already did the work. This week you copy the highlights from Weeks 1–11 onto one page. Make a copy for the pastor. Keep one with this book.

Church:

Filled in by:

Date:

Tech go-to:

Backup:

Pastor:

Where this book is kept:

Where passwords are kept:

Who can get to them:

... and:

What we use (names only)

Email:

Files:

Giving:

Member records:

Website:

Web address rented from:

Renews:

Internet

Company:

Box is located:

Who can restart it:

Equipment we can't do without:

Second copies, in one sentence:

First three calls when something breaks

1.
2.
3.

The three things that get stuck most around here

1.
2.
3.

Things we still don't know (that's okay):

Pastor's initials:

Date:

Which of these sound like us? (check any)

- ☐ Only one person knows the passwords or how things work
- ☐ Sunday tech depends on one volunteer
- ☐ Visitor follow-up lives in someone's head or inbox
- ☐ We type the same information into two or three places
- ☐ Things renew and nobody's sure who's in charge of them
- ☐ Wifi, internet, or phones quit on us mid-week or mid-service
- ☐ Someone who left may still be able to get in
- ☐ Important files live on one laptop, and we've never tried getting a file back from a backup

You're done when

the one-page summary is filled in and the pastor has read it.

- ☐ Done for this week.
- ☐ Done. All twelve weeks. Well done.

What's next

You did it. Your church's tech is out of your head and on paper. Put the book somewhere safe. Tell your backup person where it is.

Take the Friction Check (free, about 5 minutes)

It's a short quiz that asks one question: where does work get stuck? You could have guessed at it twelve weeks ago. Now you can answer from what you wrote down.

→ raytech.co/quiz

If you'd like a second set of eyes

You might look at your summary page and think, "Okay, now what?" If you'd like, I'll sit down with you, look at your notes together, and help you decide what matters first and what can wait. We start from your book, not from scratch. No pressure, and no sales pitch on the page. Just ask.

→ raytech.co or services@raytech.co. Mention that you finished the journal.

Help me make next year's better

I put out a new edition every year, and what you tell me goes straight into it. Things change every year anyway (people, bills, logins), so next year's book is also a quick way to bring your notes up to date.

Tell me what you think (about 3 minutes). You don't have to finish all 12 weeks. If you stopped early, that's exactly what I need to hear about.

→ [Go to raytech.co, open the journal page, and use the feedback link. It opens a short Google Form.](#)

Thank you. Truly.

Write it down. Serve well.

Adam Raymer-Brown · Raytech Services

Appendix A — For the board member who asks "is this a real thing?"

Yes. Writing down what you have, who can get in, where the second copies are, and who to call is the first step in the two best-known plain-sense security guides: the U.S. government's NIST Cybersecurity Framework and the nonprofit CIS Controls. Both start with the same idea: you can't look after what you haven't written down.

This journal lines up with four of their basic habits:

- Know what you have. Equipment, accounts, and files (Weeks 2, 3, 7).
- Use a second sign-in step on important accounts, and know whose phone gets the code (Week 3).
- Keep a second copy, and try getting a file back (Week 9).
- Know who has the keys, and collect them when someone leaves (Weeks 5, 10).

To be plain about it

This journal is a notebook, not an inspection. Finishing it does not make a church certified, compliant, or secure, and nobody can promise that nothing will ever go wrong. NIST and CIS have not reviewed or endorsed this book. For legal, insurance, or safety decisions, talk to someone qualified.

If you want to read more:

NIST, Cybersecurity Framework 2.0: Small Business Quick-Start Guide — nvlpubs.nist.gov (NIST.SP.1300)

GuideStone, How to Protect Your Church or Ministry Against Cyberattacks — guidestone.org

Appendix B — Hard-day pages

These two pages are for the days nobody plans for. Fill in names and places now, while things are calm, and go over them with the people named. This is not a full emergency plan. On a hard day, call 911 when it's called for, and do what first responders and your building's own plan tell you. Don't put passwords or private details about children or members on these pages.

Church:

Last looked over:

By:

Page 1 — What we'd do

If there's a threat and we need to lock down

Who tells staff, ushers, and teachers?

How?

Who locks outside doors? First:

Backup:

What do people in classrooms do?

Who can say "all clear"?

How do we know the all clear is real?

Where do parents and children meet afterward?

Who checks each child goes home with the right adult?

Call 911. Don't wait on this page, and don't go looking for the trouble yourself.

If there's severe weather

Where we shelter:

Backup spot:

Who checks restrooms, nursery, children's rooms? First:

Backup:

Where the weather radio is:

Who checks the batteries:

Other ways we get warnings:

Who decides to cancel or close?

Who posts the announcement, and where?

Who decides when we reopen?

If we can't use the building

Where we'd hold worship:

Backup:

Where office work would happen:

How we'd reach members and volunteers:

Who can get to giving records from outside?

Who can get to member records from outside?

Where the second copy of important files is (Week 9):

Who can get to it? First:

Backup:

Page 2 — Who to call and who speaks

NEED	NAME OR COMPANY	PHONE	NOTES
Emergency	911		
Insurance agent			
Tech help			
Pastor			
Power / water / gas			
Alarm company			
Children's ministry lead			

Main way we announce things:

Backup way:

Who approves what gets said publicly?

Who talks to staff and volunteers?

Who talks to families about picking up children?

Where the current phone list is kept:

Next time we'll look this over:

With:

A blank on this page is a reminder to decide ahead of time, so nobody has to guess on a hard day.

Notes

Intentional blank page (saddle-stitch page count).